

Khanya Mbutho – 23559226

JLO 310 – Individual Assignment

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I, the undersigned, hereby declare that the work submitted in this assignment is my own, original work. I understand that plagiarism—whether intentional or unintentional—is a serious academic offense and that all sources used in this work have been appropriately acknowledged and cited.

Plagiarism Declaration

I confirm that:

- This assignment has not been copied from another source, in whole or in part, without proper attribution.
- Any ideas, text, images, or other content derived from external sources have been cited correctly.
- I have not allowed anyone else to copy or use my work.
- I understand that plagiarism is a violation of academic integrity policies and that any detected instances may result in disciplinary action.

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I confirm that:

- If generative AI tools (e.g., ChatGPT, Google Bard) were used in any capacity during the completion of this assignment, I have clearly indicated how and where they were used.
- Any AI-generated content included in this assignment has been critically reviewed and supplemented with my own analysis and reasoning.
- I take full responsibility for the accuracy and validity of the information presented in this work.
- If no AI tools were used, I acknowledge that this declaration still applies to ensure transparency and integrity.

Student Details

Name: Khanya Mbutho

Student Number: u23559226

Dialogue: This is a conversation between Grade 10 learners and their LO teacher about Religions.

Miss Mbutho: Good morning grade 10s. Today we will be learning about the history and importance of religion. We will also dive into the topic of respecting other religions and promoting diversity. Can anyone tell me what religion means?

Student 1: I think religion is a specific belief or system rooting from faith.

Student 2: Religion is a guideline of values and morality.

Student 3: Religion helps individuals have more appropriate interactions within society while not losing oneself.

Miss Mbutho: All of you are correct. Religion plays different roles in our lives, and we all maybe have different views of it. I want you guys to tell me the importance of being kind and respectful to people of other religions. And this time I would like different people to answer. We always see the same hands.

Student 4: It is important and should be a priority to that there is peace and unity within the community.

Student 5: I think it should be prioritized to ensure that people are comfortable and safe , they are able to embrace their cultures and traditions in no fear whatsoever.

Student 6 : Alot of conflict can be avoided by promoting inclusivity in society where there are different views and experiences of religion.

Miss Mbutho: on the topic of religion, can Lwazi please explain to us what diversity means.

Lwazi: diversity means being open to and acknowledging the differences between a variety of different groups.

Miss Mbutho: Okay. Thank you grade 10s for answering. From all your answers, I have gathered that majority of the class has a clear understanding of what religion is, why it is important to promote diversity in society and respect other people's beliefs. All your answers are correct.

Student 7: Mam, if I may ask. How are religion and traditions connected to each other?

Miss Mbutho: They both help people feel connected to their roots and ancestors and understanding their historical background as a way of guidance and knowledge. Are there any more questions ?

Title of activity: Comparing Oneself to Others: A Discussion of Religious Perspectives.

Objective: It is to foster tolerance and emphasize the value of inclusivity by helping learners comprehend and relate to the doctrines and customs of a religion that differs from their own.

Target Audience: This activity is created for Grade 10 learners, as they all come from different religious backgrounds as well as those that are atheists.

Materials:

- Paper or tablets for notetaking.
- Access to research materials (books, internet – with appropriate guidance and supervision).
- Art supplies (paper, markers, crayons) for a visual representation.

Procedure:

1. Introduction (15 minutes):

- I'll advise them to start by talking about the variety of religions in around the world and in their neighbourhood.
- In my capacity as an educator, I will lead a quick, civil conversation regarding the meanings of "understanding," "tolerance," and "inclusion" in relation to various religious perspectives. I will stress that understanding is about acknowledging the importance of these views for others, not necessarily agreeing with them.
- After that, I'll explain the idea of "Putting oneself in another's shoes" as a strategy for developing empathy.

2. Religion Pairing (10 minutes):

- I will divide participants into pairs, pairing individuals who have different or limited knowledge of each other's religious backgrounds (if known). If the group is homogeneous, I will assign each pair a religion different from their own.
- If necessary, I will then begin with a list of several religions, such as Christianity, Islam, Judaism, Hinduism, and so on.
- I will allow pairs to choose or assign religions to ensure a variety of perspectives are explored across the group.

3. Focused Exploration (30-45 minutes):

- Each pair will then be expected to choose one religion from the pairing to research and understand. I will encourage them to focus on the following aspects (adapt based on age and available resources):
 - **Core Beliefs:** What are the central ideas or principles of this religion?
 - **Key Practices:** What are some important rituals, traditions, or ways of worship?

- **Holy Texts or Figures:** Are there important books or individuals that guide this religion?
- **Values and Ethics:** What are some of the moral or ethical guidelines emphasized in this religion?
- **A Place of Worship/Community Gathering:** Where and how do followers typically gather?
- **One thing that is particularly meaningful to followers of this religion.**

- Learners will be urged to focus on real information rather than stereotypes and to use the tools that are available with courtesy. I will stress the value of utilizing trustworthy sources when conducting online research.

4. **Empathy Building and Sharing (30-45 minutes):**

- Within each pair, students will take turns "becoming" a follower of the religion they researched.
- **Learner A** will explain to **Learner B** the key aspects of the religion they explored, speaking from the perspective of someone who believes in and practices it. They should try to convey the *meaning* and *significance* of these aspects.
- **Learner B** will actively listen and ask open-ended, respectful questions to deepen their understanding. They should concentrate on the reasons why believers value particular activities and beliefs. For instance, rather than asking "What is prayer?" they could question "How does prayer connect individuals to their faith?" or "What does prayer mean to someone who practices this religion?"
- **Learner B** will explain a new religion (either their own or another assigned one) to **Learner A** after a certain period.

5. **Group Reflection and Discussion (20-30 minutes):**

- I will call everyone back together for a discussion that I've fostered. To make sure they received an educational session in their pairs, these questions will be used.
 - What was it like to try and explain a religion from the perspective of a believer? What did you learn in the process?
 - What surprised you or challenged your initial understanding of the religion you learned about?
 - What did you learn about the values and motivations of people who follow this religion?
 - How did it feel to have someone genuinely interested in understanding your own beliefs (if shared)?
 - Why is it important to understand and tolerate different religions in our communities and the world?
 - How can inclusion benefit individuals and society as a whole?

- What are some ways we can show respect and understanding towards people with different religious beliefs in our daily lives?

I will encourage participation in the following ways:

1. Creating a Safe and Inclusive Environment

- **Establishing clear ground rules:** At the beginning of the activity, the learners and I will collaboratively establish guidelines for respectful communication, emphasizing active listening, valuing diverse opinions, and avoiding judgment or interruption.
- **Emphasizing the Goal of Learning, not "Winning":** I will present the exercise as a chance for everyone involved to learn and comprehend one another, not as a dispute or a contest to be "right."
- **Validating All Contributions:** I will acknowledge and appreciate every contribution, even if it's a simple question or observation. This can be done verbally ("That's an interesting point," "Thank you for sharing that") or nonverbally (nodding, making eye contact).
- **Being Mindful of Language:** Use inclusive language that avoids assumptions about religious beliefs or cultural backgrounds. Be sensitive to potentially triggering or offensive language.
- **Creating Opportunities for Anonymous Input :** Depending on the group's comfort level and the sensitivity of the topic, I might offer anonymous ways to share thoughts or ask questions (e.g., through sticky notes or a digital platform).

2. Employing Diverse Participation Structures:

- **Think-Pair-Share:** This allows learners to first process their thoughts privately, then discuss with a partner, before sharing with the larger group. This can be less intimidating for quieter learners.
- **Small Group Discussions:** Dividing the class into smaller groups helps foster a more personal environment where learners who are more reserved may feel more at ease contributing. I will make sure each group has a range of viewpoints.
- **Rotating Roles:** The clear roles of "explainer" and "listener" in the pair-sharing exercise guarantee that each learner has an opportunity to actively participate in both understanding and articulating.

- **Choice and Agency:** I will give learners some say in the religion they study or how they communicate what they have learned, where appropriate. Their motivation to participate and investment may rise as a result.
- **Diverse Response Formats:** I will give learners the opportunity to communicate their understanding in a variety of forms, including written notes, drawings, spoken explanations, and even brief role-playing exercises (if they feel comfortable doing so). This accommodates a variety of learning preferences and styles.

3. **Methods of Facilitation that Promote Wide-Ranging Involvement:**

- **Strategic Questioning:** Instead of asking "yes" or "no" questions, I will use open-ended questions that promote more in-depth analysis and a range of answers. I will ask questions in a variety of ways to accommodate varying comprehension levels.
- **Wait Time:** I will instruct learners to give themselves enough "think time" following a question. Before speaking, some learners require additional time to gather their thoughts.
- **Connecting Ideas:** I will make links between the contributions of diverse learners to demonstrate how different viewpoints integrate and add to a more comprehensive understanding.
- **Promoting Interaction between Peers:** I will encourage learners to reply to one another's thoughts by asking, "What do you think about what (name) shared?" This promotes a feeling of group education.
- **Modelling Respect and inquiry:** In my role as facilitator, I will continuously exhibit respectful engagement with all points of view and set an example of sincere inquiry about all religions. I set the tone for the group with my own attitude.

1. Allport, G. W. (1954). The nature of prejudice. *Reading/Addison-Wesley*.
2. Banks, J. A., & Banks, C. A. M. (Eds.). (2010). *Multicultural education: Issues and perspectives*. John Wiley & Sons.
3. Batson, C. D. (2011). *Altruism in humans*. Oxford University Press.
4. McKim, R. (2010). Responding to religious diversity: Some possible directions for the Interfaith Youth Core. *Journal of College and Character*, 11(1).
5. Tisdell, E. J. (2003). *Exploring spirituality and culture in adult and higher education*. John Wiley & Sons.



Presentation by Miss K. Mbutho

Religion & inclusion

Understanding different religions in society

LIFE ORIENTATION , GRADE 10B



MAIN TOPICS



Religion



Inclusion



Personal views



Introduction



Every individual has their own perspectives and views on religion. Those can be based on society, tradition and personal experiences. During this lesson, we will explore comparing Oneself to others and have a discussion of religious perspectives.



Understanding and Empathy:

Let's start by talking about the variety of religions in around the world and in their neighborhoods.

- civil conversation regarding the meanings of "understanding," "tolerance," and "inclusion" in relation to various religious perspectives. -
- NB: understanding is about acknowledging the importance of these views for others, not necessarily agreeing with them but showing respect.
- "Putting oneself in another's shoes" as a strategy for developing empathy.



Expected Outcomes



Religion Pairing:

- I will divide the class into pairs, pairing individuals who have different or limited knowledge of each other's religious backgrounds (if known). If the group is homogeneous, each pair will be assigned a religion different from their own.

Focused exploration:

- Each pair will then be expected to choose one religion from the pairing to research and understand. I will encourage them to focus on the following aspects (adapt based on age and available resources):
 - Core Beliefs: What are the central ideas or principles of this religion?
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 - A Place of Worship/Community Gathering: Where and how do followers typically gather?

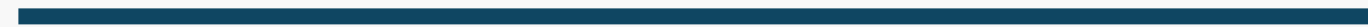
Group Reflection and Discussion :

ANSWER THE FOLLOWING QUESTIONS

- What was it like to try and explain a religion from the perspective of a believer? What did you learn in the process?
- What surprised you or challenged your initial understanding of the religion you learned about?
- What did you learn about the values and motivations of people who follow this religion?
- How did it feel to have someone genuinely interested in understanding your own beliefs (if shared)?
- Why is it important to understand and tolerate different religions in our communities and the world?
- How can inclusion benefit individuals and society as a whole?
- What are some ways we can show respect and understanding towards people with different religious beliefs in our daily lives?



Conclusion



In conclusion, inclusion, empathy, respect and understanding are all essential for humility and are needed for a better society and diversity in all aspects not just religion. I hope from today's lesson, we learnt something that will be helpful in some areas of our lives.





Thank you

